

## Wilson-Cowan-type neural activity models

In Wilson-Cowan-type models, the activity of a neural population is expressed in terms of synaptic activity  $u$ , as follows

$$\tau \dot{u} = -u + tv + h$$

where  $t$  is the proportionality constant between firing rate  $v$  and synaptic activity  $u$ . (Here I am assuming just one population so  $t > 0$  represents intrinsic recurrent excitation.) The parameter  $h$  represents synaptic activity due to extrinsic sources.

Often the following linear relationship between synaptic activity  $u$  and the resulting firing rate  $v$  is assumed,

$$v = gu + v_0,$$

where  $g > 0$  and  $v_0$  is the spontaneous firing rate (firing rate in the absence of synaptic activity). Differentiating this relationship gives  $\dot{v} = g\dot{u}$  so

$$\begin{aligned}\frac{\tau}{g}\dot{v} &= -\frac{v - v_0}{g} + tv + h \\ \tau\dot{v} &= -v + \underbrace{gt}_w v + \underbrace{gh + v_0}_f\end{aligned}$$